Digital Literacy Project Report :

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Branch : Computer Science and Engineering

Year : 2025-26

Course Code : CSE0001

Date : 30/03/26

Introduction :

This project focuses on strengthening essential digital literacy skills by completing a series of structured tasks designed to improve my online presence, communication abilities, and cyber awareness. Through tasks such as evaluating my digital footprint, creating accounts on professional platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn, and ResearchGate, and studying cyber safety through a real or fictional case study, I gained practical knowledge that is directly applicable in academic and professional settings. Each task encouraged hands-on learning—from understanding how personal information is displayed online to building a professional identity and identifying online risks such as payment fraud. Overall, this project provided a strong foundation for navigating the digital world confidently and responsibly.

Task 1 : Presentation

In Task 1, I explored my existing digital footprint by searching for my name on multiple platforms such as Google, LinkedIn, GitHub, and other publicly accessible sites. The objective was to understand how my personal information appears online and how it reflects on my digital identity. Through this activity, I realized that different platforms display different levels of information based on privacy settings, account visibility, and user activity.

I further created infographics on the sub-topics - what digital literacy is, useful digital tools for students and safe internet practices. I used Canva to create the infographic which made my task much easier. Canva had the option to decide the already made template and use it to create our owm infographic.

I documented my topics and uploaded it into the Task 1 folder of my GitHub repository. This included images, observations, and short descriptions of each. The task helped me understand the importance of maintaining a clean, professional, and secure online presence. I also learned that even small details like usernames, profile pictures, and activity history contribute to how others perceive me digitally.

Overall, Task 1 gave me better awareness of digital footprints and created the foundation for improving my professional online identity. It highlighted the need to regularly update profiles, adjust privacy settings, and stay conscious about the type of information shared online.

Task 2 : Portfolio

In Task 2, I created professional accounts on three major digital platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and ResearchGate. The purpose of this task was to build my online professional identity and understand how these platforms help in academic, networking, and career development.

First, I created and configured my GitHub account, which will serve as my primary space for hosting code, projects, and assignments. I learned how repositories work, how to upload files, and how GitHub helps maintain a clean version-controlled portfolio.

Next, I created my LinkedIn profile to establish a professional presence. This platform helps students connect with industry professionals, follow companies, learn skills through LinkedIn Learning, and showcase achievements. I added my basic details such as name, education, and skills to build a strong beginner profile.

Finally, I created an account on ResearchGate, a platform mainly used by researchers and students interested in academic work. Even though I am still a student, ResearchGate will help me explore research topics, follow authors, and understand how academic publications work.

Overall, Task 2 helped me develop a foundational professional identity on digital platforms. It made me aware of how important online profiles are for future opportunities, internships, and academic growth.

Task 3 : Platforms

Task 3 is focused on creating an account on Hackerrank and solving a basic challenge - ‘Solve me first’ which was a python challenge. I then took the screenshot of the challenge and uploaded it under the task 3 section of my github repository.

Along with the challenge, I prepared five multiple-choice questions and one short-answer question based on the topic ‘Digital literacy awareness’. The questions were formulated on the google forms. I also took two responses from my friends and their feedback was that the form made them learn something.These questions test basic awareness of cyber fraud and how to stay safe while making online transactions. I then uploaded all Task 3 files into the respective folder in my GitHub repository.

This task helped me learn about different platforms and why digital awareness is important. I also learned how to identify suspicious activities, secure personal information, and promote safe online habits. The activity strengthened my understanding of cybersecurity basics and improved my ability to analyze real-life digital risks and also motivated me to continue performing challenges to upgrade my python skills.

Task 4 : Email Etiquette

In Task 4, I learned how to write formal and professional emails for real-world situations. I created two different emails based on the instructions: one personal email and one academic/professional email. Both emails were written using proper structure, including subject line, greeting, body content, and a polite closing. After writing the emails, I exported them as PDF files and uploaded them into the Task 4 folder of my GitHub repository.

This task helped me understand the differences between informal and formal communication and the importance of clarity, tone, and correctness in digital communication. While writing the emails, I learned how to use appropriate language, avoid unnecessary details, and ensure that the message remains concise and purposeful.

Additionally, this task improved my knowledge of email etiquette—such as using a clear subject line, respecting the recipient's time, and maintaining professionalism. These skills are essential for academic use, internship applications, and future workplace communication.

Task 4 helped me build confidence in writing effective emails and strengthened my overall digital literacy by teaching me how to communicate responsibly and professionally through online platforms.

Task 5 : Cybercrime

Task 5 focuses on performing research on a cybercrime and creating a report about what it is, how it is done and in what steps is the crime performed by the scammers. I chose the topic - 'UPI/Online payment fraud' and made a case study based report on it.

While researching cybercrime topics, I was most surprised by how easily scammers can manipulate people using simple psychological tricks like urgency, fear, and fake authority. Even well-educated students fall for UPI scams because fraudulent messages and websites look so real. I also learned that many cybercrimes succeed simply because victims hesitate to report incidents quickly.

One habit I will personally change is avoiding unknown links and verifying every message before responding. I will also enable two-factor authentication on all important accounts and be more careful with online payments. This research made me more aware of how small mistakes can lead to big losses. I also learned about what steps can be taken in emergency if we became a victim of an online payment scam and whom to contact and repot immediately in such situations.

Conclusion :

This project helped me significantly improve my digital awareness, professional readiness, and online safety practices. By actively engaging in different tasks, I understood how to maintain a positive digital footprint, create professional profiles, and recognize common online frauds. The experience also enhanced my ability to use digital tools responsibly while preparing me for future academic and professional opportunities. Overall, the project successfully strengthened my digital literacy skills and provided long-term value for my personal and professional growth.

References :

GitHub Documentation. https://docs.github.com/

LinkedIn Help Center. https://www.linkedin.com/help/

ResearchGate Support. https://www.researchgate.net/

Government of India – Cyber Safety Guidelines. https://www.cybercrime.gov.in/

VIT Digital Literacy Course Materials (VITyarthi Platform)

General online tutorials and publicly available learning resources (YouTube, articles,etc.)